

Interview Checklist and Sample Questions

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Interview Checklist

FOR ALL VOLUNTEERS: Once you receive their application, we strongly recommend that you complete the following checklist.

NOTE TO SMALLER CHAPTERS: We recognize that you have often accepted an applicant when you ask them to go to score.org to complete the application. Consider the Step 1 items and insert them where they make sense in your chapter's process.

1 Google the candidate

2 Check their LinkedIn Page

3 Have an Interview (via video, phone or even in-person):

- ☐ Begin with a discussion about SCORE, including the Mission, Vision, Values, SLATE Mentoring Methodology.
- ☐ Discuss Code of Ethics. Share the code with new volunteers to make sure they're comfortable.
- ☐ Discuss the volunteer roles and opportunities available.
- ☐ Discuss the benefits to the volunteer. These may include:
 - At SCORE, you'll have the opportunity to not only give back to your local community and help the local economy, but you'll also learn new business tools and strategies
 - You'll be trained in our mentoring methodology and build skills as a mentor
 - You'll have many opportunities to network with your local community and the business leaders in it
 - You'll have public speaking opportunities, can attend regional conferences, and may work with national sponsors and alliance partners
 - You'll have the opportunity to hone your leadership skills and further build your own leadership brand
- ☐ Focus on contribution more than a specific time commitment, but also share the mentor qualifications at SCORE.
- ☐ Discuss Computer/Technology Skills.

Screening Process Recommendation: Discuss expectations with the Provisional concerning using SCORE's email (SVO), video meetings, completing the training requirements via Engage and use of the Support Center.

KEEP IN MIND

It is more important that the **SCORE** values should resonate with the potential volunteer, before recruiting for a specific chapter need.

4 Have an In-Person or Video Interview

- Choose questions from the “Open-Ended Questions” and “Either/Or Questions” to augment and round out your current interview process.
 - We have offered questions and things to listen for during the interview. Most of these suggestions have been added to tie directly to the behaviors clients have asked for and said they value most. For example:
 - Have you ever dealt with an emotional co-worker/client? How did you deal with them?
 - NOTE: This “listen for” ties directly back to the client identified values of empathy, compassion, warmth, being there for someone, and patience.
 - Other questions are offered to help you think through the attitudes of a prospective volunteer. When selecting a volunteer to join a chapter, these questions might provide insight about the volunteers fit with the direction of the chapter.
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Interview Questions

OPEN-ENDED QUESTIONS

	Question	Listen for:
1	Tell me about your professional background.	What do they think is most important in their career? Are they focused on me and I, or is there an understanding/acknowledgement of the role others played in their success?
2	Why do you want to volunteer for SCORE? What about SCORE appeals to you the most?	SCORE values Volunteer benefits should play a role, but the mission, vision, and values should also come through
3	Some version of the following: - What roles are most appealing to you? Mentor, trainer, community ambassador, etc. - How do you like or want to contribute? - What unmet need would volunteering fulfill for you?	The volunteer's answer to this question will help you determine if s/he is a good fit based on your expectations of what's needed in that role
4	Tell me about your best client or customer relationship. If no direct client experience: Tell me about a time you were a client and received exceptional service. What did that look like?	Some kind of experience working with clients versus a non-client facing role (process engineer or corporate accountant for example)
5	What is your communication style like? What way do you prefer to communicate with others?	Communication styles and how they work with volunteers and clients
6	Tell me about your professional networks. How do you link with others? Have you had experience mentoring in a group setting? If you had a client in need of help on a topic not in your area of expertise, what would you do?	Connector, rich network, links with others
7	Give me an example of a person you didn't get along with and/or had difficulty working with and why? What were their traits?	Open minded, approachable, tolerant, observant Empathy, compassion, warmth, patience Adaptable, flexible
8	Can you think of a time where an opportunity passed you by? What did you do?	Willing to experiment and take prudent risk

9	Tell me about a time you were in charge of executing a decision that did not have a consensus.	This is a key question if you are recruiting for leadership. This tells you about the ability to be assertive to drive home a point of view if necessary
10	How have you dealt with situations where you have to convince people about a change that needs to be made?	Patience
11	When someone comes to you with a problem, what steps do you take, if any, to assist?	Listening skills, not rushing to resolve a problem right away
EITHER / OR		
	Question	Listen for:
12	Would you say you were: 1) More patient than decisive, OR 2) More decisive than patient?	Option 1: Patience
13	When you counsel or mentor someone, would you say that you generally: 1) Do the most talking, because they are there to learn from you, OR 2) Ask a lot of probing questions to get their opinions, resulting in more talking time from them?	Option 2: Curious and inquisitive when giving counsel
14	When it comes to business acumen, do you consider yourself: 1) A generalist, OR 2) An expert in one area?	Generalist (This question does not apply if recruiting a Subject Matter Expert. SME's should be an expert in their area.)
15	Would you say you are generally: 1) More task-oriented, OR 2) Big-picture oriented	Big picture
16	If a client comes in and is unsure about what he wants to talk about with you or is uncertain or confused about how to proceed, are you more likely to: 1) Allow him to come to what he needs by asking questions, being silent, and letting him talk, OR 2) Offer suggestions and a framework for him to determine next steps?	Tolerance for ambiguity

WORK EXPERIENCE & BUSINESS BACKGROUND

17	Tell me about your best client/customer relationship.
18	Tell me about your professional networks.
19	Do you speak and read any languages in addition to English?
20	Are you familiar with the administrative process of starting and funding a business?
21	Many times we have clients who have a few ideas that they are considering for a small business but do not know how to choose. How would you handle such a client?

EXPECTED LEVEL OF COMMITMENT/ AVAILABILITY

17	Our onboarding consists of 21/2 hours of online modules which are typically completed in two weeks followed by a workshop attendance and three observation mentoring sessions with a coach. How will you ensure that you can complete these activities within next 30 days?
18	When are you available to mentor (weekdays during the day, weekends, and evenings)?
19	Do you volunteer with other organizations? if yes, where? how many hrs / week?
20	On Average we are looking for members who can commit an average of 10 - 15 HRS. per month including chapter meetings. How would SCORE fit in with your volunteering interest?
21	If currently working: How will volunteering with SCORE help you in your current work role?

COMFORT WITH TECHNOLOGY

22	Have you ever used a CRM such as Salesforce or Zoho?
23	How comfortable are you with using technology such as Google email, Google calendar, Zoom, spreadsheets, etc? Do you use a computer or tablet?

24	Are you familiar and comfortable using Zoom or Google Meet video meetings?
25	What is your experience in managing more than one email inbox?
26	Our expectation is that we respond to our mentoring requests within 48 hrs. How would you ensure that?

Chapter Volunteer Interview

Name of Applicant:

Date:

Interview Questionnaire

Choose 3 open-ended or either/or interview questions to build your interview questionnaire. To identify each question you choose, place the question number in the space provided. As you conduct the interview and ask the candidate your chosen questions, take notes on their specific response.

Question	Notes
Question	Notes
Question	Notes